

# SSC Maharashtra Board — Geography (Paper II)

March 2026 — Model Solutions

Time: 2 Hours

Max. Marks: 40

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## Q.1

**Q.1 Choose the correct alternative and complete the sentences:**  
**[4 Marks]**

**(1) The cheapest mode of transport is .....**

- (i) Roadways    (ii) Waterways    (iii) Airways    (iv) Railways

Waterways is the cheapest mode of transport because it uses natural water routes (rivers, seas, canals) which do not require construction and maintenance costs like roads or railways. The buoyancy of water also allows heavy goods to be transported with less energy.

|                     |
|---------------------|
| Ans: (ii) Waterways |
|---------------------|

**(2) The sunrays are perpendicular upto the ..... in India.**

- (i) Equator    (ii) Tropic of Capricorn    (iii) Tropic of Cancer    (iv) Longitude

The Tropic of Cancer (23°30'N) passes through the middle of India. The sunrays are perpendicular (directly overhead) up to the Tropic of Cancer in India. Areas south of this line experience perpendicular sunrays at some point during the year.

|                             |
|-----------------------------|
| Ans: (iii) Tropic of Cancer |
|-----------------------------|

**(3) In Brazil, a large amount of oxygen is released because of ..... forest.**

- (i) Deciduous    (ii) Thorny    (iii) Evergreen rain    (iv) Himalayan

Brazil has the Amazon Rainforest, which is the largest tropical evergreen rainforest in the world. It is called the “lungs of the Earth” because the dense evergreen rain forest releases a huge amount of oxygen through photosynthesis throughout the year.

|                           |
|---------------------------|
| Ans: (iii) Evergreen rain |
|---------------------------|

(4) **India's per capita income is less than Brazil due to . . . . .**

- (i) Low national income    (ii) Massive population    (iii) Big family size    (iv) Low foodgrain production

Per capita income = Total National Income  $\div$  Total Population. Even though India has a large national income, its massive population (over 140 crore) causes the per capita income to be lower compared to Brazil. The large denominator (population) reduces the per capita figure significantly.

Ans: (ii) Massive population

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## Q.2

**Q.2 Identify the odd factor out:**

**[4 Marks]**

**(1) States in Brazil:**

- (i) Sao Paulo    (ii) Parana    (iii) Bahia    (iv) Uruguay

Sao Paulo, Parana, and Bahia are all states in Brazil. However, **Uruguay** is not a state of Brazil; it is an independent country in South America bordering Brazil.

Ans: (iv) Uruguay — Uruguay is a separate country, not a state in Brazil.

**(2) Plateau region:**

- (i) Maharashtra    (ii) Pantanal    (iii) Karnataka    (iv) Telangana

Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Telangana are all states located on the Deccan Plateau region of India. However, **Pantanal** is not a plateau region. Pantanal is the world's largest tropical wetland, located in western Brazil.

Ans: (ii) Pantanal — Pantanal is a wetland, not a plateau region.

**(3) Heavy rainfall places in India:**

- (i) Mawsynram    (ii) Cherrapunji    (iii) Jaisalmer    (iv) Mahabaleshwar

Mawsynram, Cherrapunji, and Mahabaleshwar are places that receive very heavy rainfall in India. However, **Jaisalmer** is located in the Thar Desert of Rajasthan and receives very little rainfall (less than 25 cm annually).

Ans: (iii) Jaisalmer — Jaisalmer is a desert area with very low rainfall.

**(4) Major trading partners of Brazil:**

- (i) China    (ii) Germany    (iii) USA    (iv) Canada

China, Germany, and USA are major trading partners of Brazil. These countries have significant import-export trade with Brazil. However, **Canada** is not among the major trading partners of Brazil compared to the other three.

|                |
|----------------|
| Ans: (i) China |
|----------------|

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## Q.3

### Q.3 State whether the sentences are right or wrong (any *four*): [4 Marks]

- (1) Naldurg is a hill fort.

**Wrong.**

Naldurg is **not** a hill fort. Naldurg is a **plateau fort (land fort)** located in Osmanabad (Dharashiv) district of Maharashtra. It is situated on a flat plateau region, not on a hill. Hill forts are built on hills, such as Raigad and Pratapgad.

- (2) Brazil has the largest number of vegetation species in the world.

**Right.**

Brazil has the largest number of vegetation species in the world. The Amazon Rainforest, which covers a large part of Brazil, contains the richest biodiversity on the planet with thousands of plant species, making Brazil the country with the highest number of vegetation species globally.

- (3) Goa is not the most urbanised State.

**Wrong.**

Goa **is** the most urbanised state in India. According to the Census of India 2011, Goa has the highest percentage of urban population (62.17%) among all the states of India. So the statement "Goa is not the most urbanised State" is wrong.

- (4) Fishing is concentrated in the South-Eastern coast of Brazil.

**Right.**

Fishing is concentrated in the South-Eastern coast of Brazil. The coast of South-Eastern Brazil, particularly around Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo, has favourable conditions for fishing, including the presence of the cold Falkland current that brings nutrient-rich waters, making it ideal for fishing activities.

(5) Tourism is an invisible trade.

**Right.**

Tourism is classified as an invisible trade because it involves the exchange of services rather than tangible goods. When tourists visit a country, the money they spend on services like hotels, food, transport, and entertainment is counted as invisible trade (trade in services) in the balance of payments.

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## Q.4

**Q.4 (A) Mark the following in the outline map of Brazil and give index (any *four*):** [4 Marks]

1. Coal producing regions
2. Rio de Janeiro
3. Thorny shrubs in Brazil
4. Equator
5. River Paraguay
6. States with lowest urban population

**Ans:**

*(The student should mark the following on the outline map of Brazil and prepare an index.)*

| Sr. No. | Item                                | Location on Map                                     |
|---------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1       | Coal producing regions              | Southern Brazil (Rio Grande do Sul, Santa Catarina) |
| 2       | Rio de Janeiro                      | South-Eastern coast of Brazil                       |
| 3       | Thorny shrubs in Brazil             | North-Eastern interior of Brazil (Caatinga region)  |
| 4       | Equator                             | Passes through the northern part of Brazil          |
| 5       | River Paraguay                      | Flows through western Brazil (Mato Grosso do Sul)   |
| 6       | States with lowest urban population | Northern states (Amazonas, Pará, Maranhão)          |

*Note: Mark any four of the above on the outline map of Brazil supplied and write the index beside the map.*

**Q.4 (B) Observe the map of India and answer the following questions (any *four*):** [4 Marks]

*(The given map shows INDIA – Main Rivers and Lakes)*

**(1) Name the lake to the far North of India.**

**Ans:** The lake to the far north of India is **Wular Lake**. It is located in Jammu & Kashmir and is one of the largest freshwater lakes in Asia.

**(2) Name the major west flowing rivers in Central India.**

**Ans:** The major west flowing rivers in Central India are **River Narmada** and **River Tapi (Tapti)**. Both these rivers originate in Central India and flow westward into the Arabian Sea. River Narmada originates from Amarkantak in Madhya Pradesh and River Tapi originates from Multai in Madhya Pradesh.

**(3) Where does the river Kaveri originate?**

**Ans:** The River Kaveri (Cauvery) originates at **Talakaveri** in the **Brahmagiri Hills** of the Western Ghats in **Kodagu (Coorg) district of Karnataka**. It flows through Karnataka and Tamil Nadu before draining into the Bay of Bengal.

**(4) River Manas is the tributary of which river?**

**Ans:** River Manas is a tributary of the **River Brahmaputra**. The Manas River flows through Bhutan and Assam (India) before joining the Brahmaputra River in Assam.

**(5) What does the map indicate?**

**Ans:** The map indicates **the main rivers and lakes of India**. It shows the major river systems including the Ganga, Brahmaputra, Indus, Narmada, Tapi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri, Mahanadi and important lakes such as Wular Lake, Chilika Lake, Sambhar Lake, Vembanad Lake, and Lake Lonar among others.

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## **Q.5**

**Q.5 Give geographical reasons (any *two*):** **[6 Marks]**

**(1) Snowfall doesn't always occur in Brazil.**

**Ans:**

- Brazil is largely a tropical country. Most of Brazil lies between the Equator and the Tropic of Capricorn.
- Due to its tropical location, Brazil receives high temperatures throughout the year, and the average temperature remains above freezing point in most regions.
- Snowfall requires temperatures below 0°C, which rarely occurs in Brazil except in the extreme southern highlands (Serra Catarinense and Serra Gaúcha) during winter.

- The warm ocean currents (Brazil Current) along the east coast keep the temperatures warm.
- Therefore, snowfall doesn't always occur in Brazil; it is a rare phenomenon limited to the extreme southern highland areas only during intense cold waves.

## **(2) India's population density is high.**

**Ans:**

- India's population density is high because India has the second largest population in the world (over 140 crore) spread over a relatively limited geographical area of 32.87 lakh sq. km.
- India has vast fertile plains (Indo-Gangetic Plains) with rich alluvial soil, adequate water supply, and favourable climate, which support dense settlements and agriculture.
- Early development of agriculture and irrigation facilities attracted large settlements in river valleys.
- Industrial growth and urbanisation have led to concentration of population in urban areas.
- High birth rate, better medical facilities reducing death rate, and improved life expectancy have contributed to the rapid growth of population.
- Therefore, due to favourable geographical conditions, fertile land, and rapid population growth, India's population density is high.

## **(3) Availability of water is a major factor affecting settlements.**

**Ans:**

- Water is one of the most basic necessities for human survival. People need water for drinking, cooking, bathing, agriculture, and industrial purposes.
- Historically, all major civilizations and settlements developed near rivers, lakes, or other water bodies (e.g., Indus Valley Civilization along the Indus River, settlements along the Ganga).
- In areas where water is abundantly available (river banks, lake shores, well-irrigated regions), dense and permanent settlements develop.
- In contrast, arid and semi-arid regions with scarce water supply (e.g., Thar Desert, Sahara) have sparse settlements and nomadic lifestyles.
- Water availability also determines the type of agriculture, which in turn determines the economic activities and population concentration.
- Therefore, availability of water is a critical factor that directly affects the location, density, and type of human settlements.

**(4) There is mixed economy in Brazil and India.**

**Ans:**

- A mixed economy is one in which both the public (government) sector and the private sector coexist and contribute to the economic development of the country.
  - In India, the government owns and operates key industries like railways, defence, and atomic energy, while the private sector is active in IT, manufacturing, agriculture, and services.
  - In Brazil, the government controls key sectors like petroleum (Petrobras) and electricity, while the private sector plays a major role in agriculture (coffee, sugarcane, soybean), manufacturing, and mining.
  - Both countries have adopted the mixed economy model to ensure equitable distribution of resources while promoting economic growth through private enterprise.
  - Neither country follows a purely capitalist nor a purely socialist model; both combine elements of both systems.
  - Therefore, both Brazil and India have mixed economies where the government and private sector work together for economic development.
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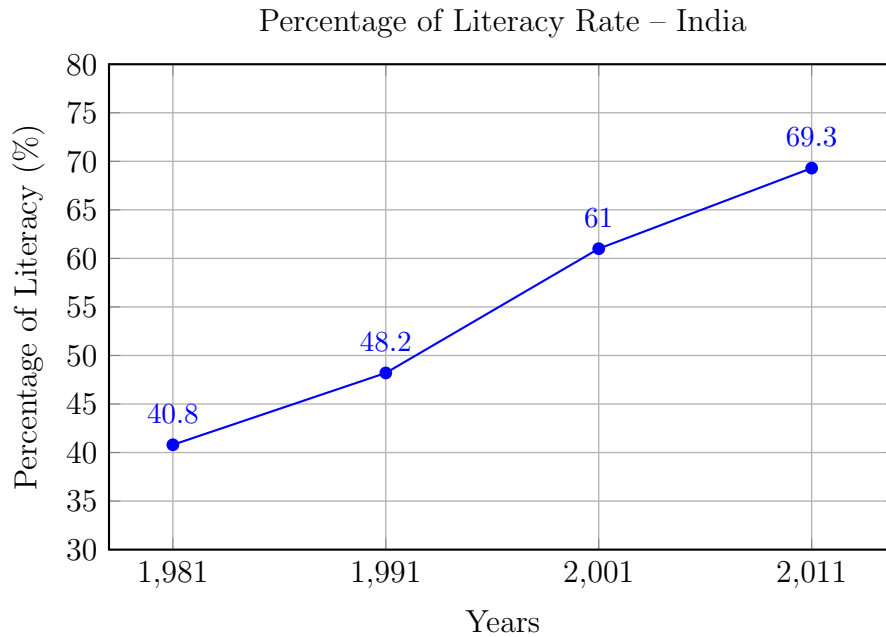
## **Q.6**

**Q.6 (A) With the help of given statistical data, prepare a simple line graph and answer the following questions: [6 Marks]**

**Percentage of literacy rate – India**

| <b>Years</b> | <b>% of Literacy</b> |
|--------------|----------------------|
| 1981         | 40.8                 |
| 1991         | 48.2                 |
| 2001         | 61.0                 |
| 2011         | 69.3                 |

**Simple Line Graph:**



### Questions & Answers:

(1) What is the literacy rate in the year 2011?

**Ans:** The literacy rate in the year 2011 is **69.3%**.

(2) In the decade from 1991 to 2001, how much was an increase in literacy rate?

**Ans:** Literacy rate in 1991 = 48.2%

Literacy rate in 2001 = 61.0%

Increase in literacy rate =  $61.0 - 48.2 = 12.8\%$

|                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Increase in literacy rate from 1991 to 2001 = 12.8% |
|-----------------------------------------------------|

(3) In which year is the literacy rate upto 40.8%?

**Ans:** The literacy rate was 40.8% in the year **1981**.

|           |
|-----------|
| Ans: 1981 |
|-----------|

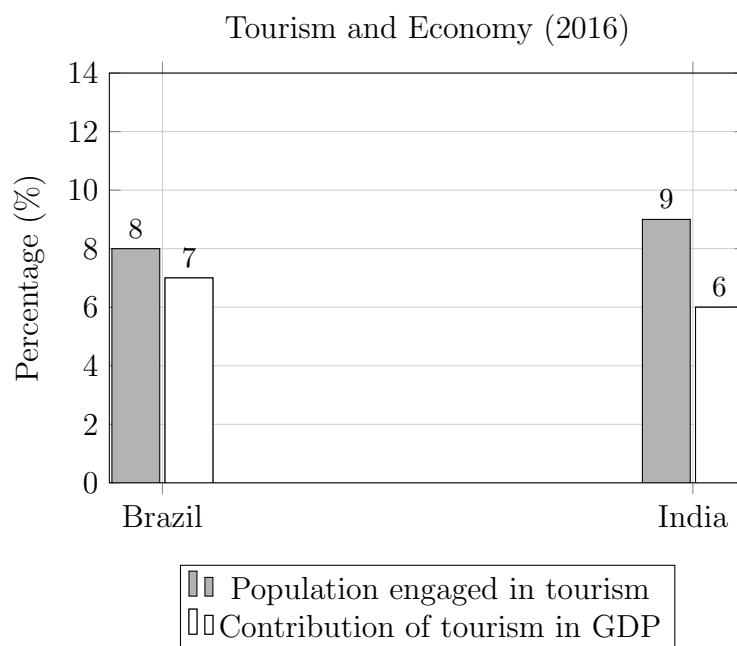
*Or*



**Q.6 (B) Read the graph and answer the following questions: [6 Marks]**

*(The graph shows a compound bar graph titled “Tourism and Economy (2016)” comparing Brazil and India on two parameters: Percentage of population engaged in tourism, and Contribution of tourism in GDP)*

**Graph Description:**



**Questions & Answers:**

**(1) What type of graph is shown here?**

**Ans:** The graph shown here is a **Compound Bar Graph** (also called a grouped/clustered bar graph). It compares two different variables (percentage of population engaged in tourism and contribution of tourism in GDP) for two countries (Brazil and India) side by side.

**(2) What does the graph show?**

**Ans:** The graph shows the **Tourism and Economy data for the year 2016**. It compares Brazil and India on two parameters — (i) Percentage of population engaged in tourism, and (ii) Contribution of tourism in GDP (Gross Domestic Product).

**(3) Which country’s tourism has a large share in the contribution towards GDP?**

**Ans:** **Brazil’s** tourism has a larger share in the contribution towards GDP. From the graph, the contribution of tourism in GDP for Brazil is approximately **7%**, while for India it is approximately **6%**. Therefore, Brazil’s tourism contributes more to its GDP.

(4) How much percentage of population in India is engaged in tourism?

**Ans:** According to the graph, approximately **9%** of the population in India is engaged in tourism.

(5) How much difference do you find in the population engaged in tourism in both the countries?

**Ans:** Population engaged in tourism in India = 9%

Population engaged in tourism in Brazil = 8%

Difference = 9% – 8% = **1%**

Therefore, there is a difference of **1%** in the population engaged in tourism between India and Brazil.

(6) Which country has a large population engaged in tourism sector but contributes less in GDP?

**Ans:** **India** has a large population engaged in tourism sector (9%) but contributes less in GDP (6%). In comparison, Brazil has 8% population engaged in tourism but contributes 7% to GDP. This means India has more people working in tourism but the economic output (GDP contribution) is relatively lower.

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## Q.7

**Q.7 Answer in detail (any *two*):** **[8 Marks]**

(1) What environmental issues are faced by Brazil and India?

**Ans:**

Both Brazil and India, being large developing countries, face several serious environmental issues:

**Environmental issues faced by Brazil:**

- **Deforestation:** The Amazon Rainforest, which is the largest tropical rainforest in the world, is being rapidly destroyed for cattle ranching, soybean farming, logging, and mining. Millions of hectares of forest are cleared every year, leading to loss of biodiversity and contributing to global climate change.
- **Loss of Biodiversity:** Due to deforestation and habitat destruction, many plant and animal species in Brazil are endangered or becoming extinct. The Amazon houses about 10% of all species on Earth.
- **Water Pollution:** Industrial waste, mining activities, and agricultural runoff pollute rivers like the Amazon, Paraná, and São Francisco. Mercury contamination from gold mining is a major issue.
- **Air Pollution:** Large cities like São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro face severe air pollution due to vehicular emissions and industrial activities.

- **Soil Degradation:** Overuse of land for agriculture and cattle ranching leads to soil erosion and desertification, especially in the Cerrado region.

#### **Environmental issues faced by India:**

- **Air Pollution:** India has some of the most polluted cities in the world (Delhi, Kanpur, Varanasi). Vehicular emissions, industrial pollution, crop burning, and construction dust contribute to severe air quality problems.
- **Water Pollution:** Rivers like the Ganga, Yamuna, and many others are heavily polluted with industrial effluents, sewage, and agricultural chemicals. The government has launched projects like “Namami Gange” to clean the rivers.
- **Deforestation:** Forests are being cleared for agriculture, urbanisation, and infrastructure development. This leads to soil erosion, floods, and loss of wildlife habitat.
- **Solid Waste Management:** Rapid urbanisation has led to a massive increase in solid waste generation. Many cities lack proper waste management systems, leading to overflowing landfills.
- **Climate Change:** Rising temperatures, erratic monsoons, melting Himalayan glaciers, and increased frequency of extreme weather events (floods, droughts, cyclones) are affecting India.
- **Soil Degradation:** Excessive use of chemical fertilizers, overgrazing, and deforestation lead to soil erosion and loss of soil fertility.

#### **(2) Describe the latitudinal and longitudinal extent of India and Brazil.**

**Ans:**

##### **Latitudinal and Longitudinal Extent of India:**

- **Latitudinal Extent:** India extends from **8°4’N** (Kanyakumari / Indira Point) to **37°6’N** (Indira Col, near Siachen Glacier in Jammu & Kashmir).
- The total latitudinal extent of India is approximately **29°2’** (about 30 degrees) from south to north.
- The **Tropic of Cancer (23°30’N)** passes through the middle of India, dividing it into the Tropical Zone (south) and the Sub-Tropical Zone (north).
- **Longitudinal Extent:** India extends from **68°7’E** (Ghuar Mota in Gujarat) to **97°25’E** (Kibithu in Arunachal Pradesh).
- The total longitudinal extent of India is approximately **29°18’** (about 30 degrees) from west to east.
- The **Standard Meridian of India (82°30’E)** passes through Mirzapur (Uttar Pradesh) and determines the Indian Standard Time (IST).

- Due to the vast longitudinal extent, there is a time difference of about 2 hours between the eastern and western extremes of India.

### Latitudinal and Longitudinal Extent of Brazil:

- **Latitudinal Extent:** Brazil extends from **5°16'N** to **33°45'S**.
- The total latitudinal extent of Brazil is approximately **39 degrees** from north to south.
- Both the **Equator (0°)** and the **Tropic of Capricorn (23°30'S)** pass through Brazil.
- Most of Brazil lies in the Southern Hemisphere and in the Tropical Zone.
- **Longitudinal Extent:** Brazil extends from **34°47'W** to **73°59'W**.
- The total longitudinal extent of Brazil is approximately **39 degrees** from east to west.
- Due to the vast longitudinal extent, Brazil has **four time zones**.

### Comparison:

| Feature              | India             | Brazil                       |
|----------------------|-------------------|------------------------------|
| Latitudinal Extent   | 8°4'N to 37°6'N   | 5°16'N to 33°45'S            |
| Total Latitude Span  | ≈ 30°             | ≈ 39°                        |
| Longitudinal Extent  | 68°7'E to 97°25'E | 34°47'W to 73°59'W           |
| Total Longitude Span | ≈ 30°             | ≈ 39°                        |
| Important Lines      | Tropic of Cancer  | Equator, Tropic of Capricorn |
| Hemisphere           | Northern          | Mostly Southern              |
| Time Zones           | 1 (IST)           | 4                            |

### (3) Suggest your measures for conservation of Historical places.

**Ans:**

Historical places are an invaluable heritage that connects us to our past. Conserving these places is essential for preserving our culture, identity, and history. The following measures can be suggested for the conservation of historical places:

1. **Legal Protection:** Historical monuments and heritage sites should be declared as "Protected Monuments" under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act (AMASR Act). This provides legal protection against encroachment, damage, and unauthorized construction.
2. **Regular Maintenance and Restoration:** Government agencies like the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) and respective State Archaeology Departments should carry out regular maintenance, repair, and scientific restoration of historical structures.
3. **Creating Buffer Zones:** A buffer zone should be established around heritage sites where no construction or commercial activity is permitted. This helps in preserving the original environment and ambiance of the historical place.

4. **Public Awareness and Education:** People should be made aware of the historical and cultural significance of these places through school education, media campaigns, exhibitions, and heritage walks. This creates a sense of pride and responsibility among citizens.
5. **Controlled Tourism:** While tourism brings revenue, uncontrolled tourism can damage heritage sites. Entry should be regulated, carrying capacity should be defined, and anti-littering rules should be strictly enforced.
6. **Documentation and Digital Preservation:** All historical places should be thoroughly documented through photography, videography, 3D scanning, and digital archiving. This ensures that even if physical damage occurs, the record is preserved.
7. **Community Participation:** Local communities living near heritage sites should be involved in conservation efforts. They can serve as custodians of these sites and benefit economically through heritage tourism.
8. **Strict Penalties for Vandalism:** Strict laws and penalties should be enforced against those who damage, deface, or vandalize historical monuments. CCTV surveillance should be installed at important sites.
9. **International Cooperation:** India should seek help from international organizations like UNESCO for the conservation of important heritage sites. Many Indian sites are already UNESCO World Heritage Sites.
10. **Funding:** Adequate funds should be allocated by the government for conservation. Public-private partnerships and corporate CSR funds can also be utilized for heritage conservation.

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— END OF SOLUTIONS —